

```

        return None

    self.balance = self.balance - amountToWithdraw
    return self.balance

    ❷ def getBalance(self, password):
        if password != self.password:
            print('Sorry, incorrect password')
            return None
        return self.balance

    # Added for debugging
    ❸ def show(self):
        print('        Name:', self.name)
        print('        Balance:', self.balance)
        print('        Password:', self.password)
        print()

```

Listing 4-1: A minimal `Account` class

NOTE

The error handling in [Listing 4-1](#) is very simple. If we find an error condition, we print an error message and return a special value of `None`. Later in the chapter, I will show a better way of handling errors.

Notice how these methods manipulate and remember data. Data is passed into each method through parameters, which are local variables that only exist while the method is running. Data is remembered in instance variables, which have object scope and therefore remember their values across calls to different methods.

First we have the `__init__()` method ❶, with three parameters. When an object is created from this class, three pieces of data are required: name, balance, and password. The instantiation might look like this:

```
oAccount = Account('Joe Schmoe', 1000, 'magic')
```

When we instantiate the object, the values of the three arguments are passed into the `__init__()` method, which in turn assigns these values to the